

BEN SLIMA Mahdi

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SUMMARY

DevSecOps & Platform Engineer with a specialization in Cloud-Native infrastructure and High-Availability migrations and automated compliance (ANSSI, GDPR, CIS Benchmarks).

Proven expertise in building Zero-Trust architectures and managing on-premise and cloud clusters with performance and security in mind.

Recognized by Oneex (France) leadership for technical skills, Seeking to leverage SRE skills in the Netherlands

WORK EXPERIENCE

Devaura

September 2025 - January 2026

Technical Lead

Sfax, Tunisia

- Directed end-to-end technical delivery for the first 3 clients, managing the full lifecycle from architecture design to deployment on OVH, and AWS Cloud providers.
- Lead the engineering hiring process, conducting technical interviews and code reviews to establish a high-performance development team.
- Deployed a containerized staging and production environments using Docker and automated resource provisioning via IaC with integrated telemetry and monitoring using OpenTelemetry, Grafana, and Prometheus.

Oneex

February 2025 - September 2025

DevOps Intern

Clermont Ferrand, France

- Architected multi-region cloud environments using Terraform and Ansible and implemented ArgoCD for GitOps, reducing deployment lead time by 95% (from days to ~5 minutes)
- Spearheaded production migration of legacy workloads to Kubernetes (RKE2 on premise), designing custom failover strategies that maintained 99.99% uptime during cutover using Ceph storage and HA failover at the hypervisor level and LGTM stack for monitoring for early threat and errors detection.
- Designed a global failover strategy utilizing Cloudflare Secondary DNS for automated site-level redirection and K8s HA deployments to ensure zero-downtime service continuity.
- Hardened clusters via Vault & Consul for mTLS and secrets management, enforced CIS Benchmarks, K8s Network Policies, and pfSense for granular traffic control, achieving 100% ANSSI and GDPR alignment.
- Integrated automated vulnerability scanning in Harbor and implemented Fail2ban for intrusion prevention,

PerfectSoft

June 2024 - August 2024

DevOps Intern

Sfax, Tunisia

- Deployed Azure-based monitoring stack (Prometheus, Grafana, Loki), enabling proactive operational stability and real-time performance tracking across core services.
- Implemented Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC) using Terraform to manage internal services, alongside automated patching workflows to enhance security compliance.

DataSphera

June 2023 - August 2023

DevOps Intern

Sfax, Tunisia

- Developed and deployed highly efficient CI/CD pipelines in GitLab CI for EKS clusters
- Integrated security scanning and compliance tools (Trivy, SonarQube) directly into the CI/CD pipeline for mandatory secure production readiness.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

IEEE Faculty of sciences of Sfax student branch

2024 - 2025

Student Branch Chair

- Led a 300+ member organization; achieved Exemplary Student Branch Award and multiple national technical competition wins.

Securinets Faculty of sciences of Sfax

2023 - 2024

Technical Manager

- Directed the technical team for cybersecurity workshops and CTF competitions, successfully elevating team skill proficiency and ensuring operational reliability for over 20 hands-on events.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Internal Developer Platform (IDP) with GitOps & Policy-as-Code

- Developed a self-service IDP using Backstage and ArgoCD, reducing developer onboarding time and environment bootstrapping from days to minutes.
- Engineered a GitOps workflow for multi-cluster management, implementing automated drift detection and reconciliation to ensure 100% environment consistency.
- Hardened cluster security by architecting a Zero-Trust model with HashiCorp Vault for dynamic secrets and OPA/Kyverno for real-time policy enforcement.
- Automated SOC2/GDPR compliance checks via Policy-as-Code, ensuring all deployed microservices adhere to organizational security benchmarks by default.

Multi-Region Disaster Recovery Strategy for Kubernetes (Velero)

- Engineered and tested a disaster recovery (DR) strategy for a production application using Velero to automatically back up application state and persistent volumes (PVs) from a primary AWS region to a secondary Azure region.
- Automated the entire backup and restoration workflow via a scheduled CronJob within Kubernetes, ensuring compliance with a target Recovery Point Objective (RPO) of < 1 hour.
- Developed and executed runbooks for simulated failover drills, successfully validating application restoration and data integrity in the secondary region.

Implementing Zero Trust Architecture with Service Mesh (Istio)

- Deployed a multi-service application into Kubernetes and implemented mutual TLS (mTLS) using Istio to enforce Zero Trust security between all internal services.
- Configured advanced traffic routing, canary deployments, and circuit breaking policies at the service mesh layer to ensure high availability and minimize blast radius for updates.
- Integrated the service mesh with Prometheus and Grafana to provide real-time, fine-grained observability and audit logging of service-to-service communication latency and errors.

MLOps Pipeline Setup

- Engineered a production-grade MLOps lifecycle for house price prediction, reducing model release cycles by 40% through automated CI/CD with GitHub Actions.
- Architected a dual-layer monitoring strategy using Arize for model drift and CloudWatch/Grafana for infrastructure health, ensuring high availability of the FastAPI inference layer.
- Implemented DVC and MLflow for rigorous data lineage and experiment tracking, achieving 100% reproducibility across multi-cloud environments.
- Standardized deployment to AWS ECS using containerization (Docker) and automated unit testing with Pytest and Deepchecks to enforce "Zero-Bug" deployment gates.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Microsoft Certified:** Azure Fundamentals · Azure AI Fundamentals · Azure Data Fundamentals · Security, Compliance & Identity Fundamentals
- **Cisco Certifications:** Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA), Cisco Certified Technician (CCT)
- **Courses:** Advanced Kubernetes / AKS Network & Infrastructure · Kubernetes Fundamentals

SKILLS

- **Cloud & Platforms :** AWS (EKS, ECS, S3), Azure (AKS, Sentinel), GCP, OVH Cloud, Cloudflare
- **Orchestration & IaC :** Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, Helm, Docker, Vagrant
- **CI/CD & GitOps :** ArgoCD (GitOps), GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Backstage (IDP)
- **Observability & SRE :** Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, ELK Stack (Loki), Alertmanager
- **Security & Governance :** HashiCorp Vault, OPA/Kyverno (Policy-as-Code), Istio (Service Mesh), Wazuh
- **Development :** Node.js, TypeScript (Next.js, React Native), Python (FastAPI, MLOps), Go
- **Data & ML Tech :** PostgreSQL, DVC, MLflow, Deepchecks, Arize (ML Monitoring)

EDUCATION

Faculty of sciences , University of Sfax

National Engineering Diploma in Data Engineering

September 2020 - October 2025

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native

English: C2 (Proficient) - TOEIC: 900/980 / CEFR C2

French: C1 (Professional)

German: A2 (Pre-Intermediate)